had become some kind of bargaining chip." Castro was not only not consulted but not even informed about the deal by his Soviet ally.[2]

"Concessions on the part of the Soviet Union produced a sense of oppressiveness," said Castro to the visiting Soviet dignitary Anastas Mikoyan a few days later. "Psychologically our people were not prepared for that. A feeling of deep disappointment, bitterness and pain has appeared, as if we were deprived not only of the missiles but of the very symbol of solidarity. Reports of missile launchers being dismantled and returned to the USSR at first seemed to our people to be an insolent lie." Castro found Khrushchev's agreement to allow the UN to inspect the missile sites on Cuban territory even more offensive; again, the Cubans had not even been consulted. "The Soviet Union gave its consent for inspections also without sending a notification to the Cuban leadership," he told Mikoyan. "It is necessary to take into account the special delicacy of our people, which has been created as a result of several historic developments. The Platt Amendment, imposed by the Americans upon Cuba, played a particular role in this regard."[3]

It is not clear whether Mikoyan knew who Platt was, but Castro had in mind an amendment to the Army Appropriations Bill of 1901 passed by the US Congress in March of that year and named after Senator Orville Platt, who presented it. It allowed the United States to lease and buy lands in Cuba for its military bases (Guantánamo among them), prohibited the country from going into debt, and limited its sovereignty over its foreign affairs. All that was done without consulting the Cuban government. Castro implied that the Soviet Union was now acting in similar fashion. Castro was personally offended, but his grievances were more than a reflection of his own hurt pride. They expressed the feelings of the Cuban leadership and its revolutionary supporters, all of whom felt betrayed.[4]

While Kennedy spent many agonizing hours and whole days arguing with his aides on how to get the Turks on board with the removal of the Jupiter missiles and how to convince the NATO allies to go along with the decision, Khrushchev devoted little or no time to thinking about Castro and his possible reaction. He expected Castro to fall into line: as a client and junior member of the communist club, he was to follow the policy adopted by his protector and communist supreme leader. That was what the East